

Tracked Infantry Fighting Vehicles

Armored Personnel Carriers (APCs) allowed infantry to operate alongside tanks, but their thinner armor, lighter firepower, and limited mobility left them vulnerable to attack. To rectify this, designers turned their attention to developing vehicles that could not only fight alongside tanks, but freed their infantry to engage the enemy without leaving the vehicle. These new infantry fighting vehicles (IFVs) greatly sped up operations, and gave the crew greater protection against conventional threats and the atmospheric contamination expected on a nuclear battlefield.

▽ BMP-1

Date 1966 **Country** Soviet Union
Weight 14.9 tons (13.5 tonnes)
Engine UTD 20 diesel, 300 hp
Main armament 73 mm 2A28 smoothbore gun

The appearance of the BMP-1, the first true IFV, caused great concern in the West. Its firepower, protection, and capacity for eight infantrymen were unprecedented. However, it had flaws: it was cramped, vulnerable to mines, and its fuel tanks were located between the infantry's seats.



Individual suspension
on first and sixth wheels

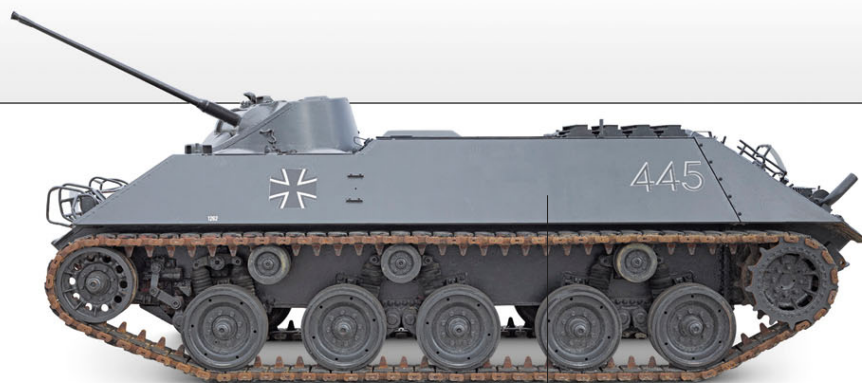
▷ BMD-1

Date 1969 **Country** Soviet Union
Weight 8.3 tons (7.5 tonnes)
Engine 5D-20 diesel, 240 hp
Main armament 73 mm 2A28 smoothbore gun

A lightly armored IFV for Soviet Airborne Troops, the BMD-1 could be dropped by parachute. It used the same turret as the BMP-1 and served alongside the turretless BTR-D APC, which carried 10 infantry. The BMD-1 carried four infantry and had a four-man crew, including a bow gunner.



Light armor suitable
for airdropping



△ Schützenpanzer Lang HS.30

Date 1958 **Country** West Germany
Weight 16.1 tons (14.6 tonnes)
Engine Rolls-Royce B81 Mark 80F gasoline, 220 hp
Main armament 20 mm Hispano-Suiza HS.820 cannon

According to West German military doctrine, tanks, infantry, and infantry carriers were to fight alongside each other. Accordingly, the Schützenpanzer Lang was more heavily armed and armored than contemporary APCs, and had a lower profile. It had a capacity for five infantry, who entered and left via roof hatches. Unreliable at first, it improved after costly modification.

Characteristically
low profile



73 mm 2A28
smoothbore gun